

SENATE RESOLUTION 36

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Kortland Whalum of Memphis.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts and artistic contributions, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Kortland Whalum of Memphis, whose current work in the theatrical world is a continuing example of his personal excellence and another monument of talent for his hometown; and

WHEREAS, Kortland Whalum hails from the highly respected Whalum family of Memphis, the members of which, over four generations, have distinguished themselves time and again in the fields of music, worship, and public service; and

WHEREAS, rather than attempting to follow the same musical path as his siblings, Kortland Whalum chose to develop his vocal capacity, and drawn by the magic of the stage, he began a successful career in theater, starring in Memphis productions of *Cats* and *Raisin*; and

WHEREAS, after he returned from college in New York City, New York, to work in the Memphis theater community, Mr. Whalum also dedicated his time to teaching at the Stax Music Academy, and he now sits on the board of the Memphis Listening Lab, a nonprofit vinyl record library; and

WHEREAS, with an ever-expansive creative spirit and impulse, Mr. Whalum released a neo soul EP in 2021 titled *A Love Letter*, which featured many of his talented relatives showcasing their mastery of their particular instruments; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Whalum epitomizes the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this legislative body should pause to honor the exceptional service of Kortland Whalum; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the service of Kortland Whalum, reflecting on his contributions to music and theater and his enduring legacy of excellence and service.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.